

TAB 21



Board of Education Report

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Mr. Schmerelson, Dr. Rivas - Read Across America Week (Res-021-23/24)(For Action February 13, 2024)

Whereas, Reading is a fundamental skill for all people that incorporates into nearly every aspect of their academic, professional, and personal lives;

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District is committed to literacy excellence through its strategic pillar to provide high-quality instruction, college readiness, and the elimination of opportunity gaps for all students;

Whereas, The National Center for Education Statistics stated that, based on the NAEP, only 31% of California students were proficient or above in reading in the year 2022;

Whereas, The District saw a 9-point increase in reading scores for the 2021-2022 school year;

Whereas, According to the California Assessment of Student Performance and Progress system, 41.17% of district students met or exceeded the English Language Arts standard, below the state average of 46.66%;

Whereas, The District has taken the initiative to hire and retain interventionists, who assist students with reading and comprehension from elementary to high school;

Whereas, The District has hired literacy coaches to help train educators and staff in literacy strategies;

Whereas, The District acknowledges the difficulties some students face in their academics due to historical and systemic lack of resources to aid in their educational pursuits;

Whereas, The District recently adopted literacy strategies and models that align with the science of reading, training 3,213 teachers, including 350 special educators in LETRS and 6,783 teachers, including 634 special educators, in Orton-Gillingham;

Whereas, Read Across America Week was started by the National Education Association (NEA) in 1998 to celebrate and acknowledge the importance of reading to students;

Whereas, The Start of Read Across America Week is on March 2, to commemorate the beloved children's author, Theodor Seuss Geisel, more commonly known as Dr. Seuss; and

Whereas, Read Across America Week is celebrated throughout the country, commemorated through public readings and events that celebrate literature; now, therefore be it,

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District Commemorates Read Across America Week during the week starting March 2 to March 6, 2023;

Resolved further, That the Los Angeles Unified School District encourages teachers, staff, students, and parents, to establish or reestablish their connections to their favorite pieces of literature;

Resolved further, That the District encourages the entire Los Angeles Unified community, including

parents, to also be involved in reading, and suggests parent centers to also talk to parents about the importance of reading to their children starting at young ages;

Resolved further, That the District encourages schools to host appropriate events at their sites during Read Across America Week, with displays, readings from teachers and parents, or other creative ways to enhance students' love for reading;

Resolved further, That the District reaffirms its commitment to the current timeline that by 2026, 3rd-grade students will be 30 points closer to proficiency in English Language Arts while helping students in grades 3-8 and 11th closer to proficiency; and, be it finally;

Resolved, That the District wishes every member of the Los Angeles Unified Community happy reading during our celebration.